

Week 1.2

grammar: review of past tenses

pronunciation: emphatic *do/did* for contrast

grammar: would/used to

Read the following blog extract. What was difficult for Akna when she moved to the city?

Hi, I'm Akna! I grew up in remote northern Canada, as a member of an Indigenous community. My people are Inuit, and up to the age of 18 I spent my days in a very traditional way: foraging, cooking, as well as attending a local school. And then my life changed completely when I met Jordan. Jordan had arrived in my area as an anthropologist a year before I met him, and he was studying our language and traditions. We fell in love and eventually we got married and moved to Montreal. I did try to fit in, but I really suffered from culture shock and felt out of place. I was scared of losing my identity and didn't know who I was anymore. After a long struggle, I finally realised that my family background and community had made me who I was, but that my choices have made me who I am today.

Which is correct?

- a. When I was young, I went fishing almost every day.
- b. When I was young, I was going fishing almost every day.

Finish Akna's blog entry with the right form of the verbs.

This (1) _____ (*happen*) soon after Jordan and I (2) _____ (*move*) here. That day, it (3) _____ (*snow*) and the wind (4) _____ (*blow*) really hard. I (5) _____ (*be*) in Montreal for two months, and I (6) _____ (*miss*) my family really badly. The St. Lawrence River (7) _____ (*freeze*) over a month before, and I (8) _____ (*decide*) to go ice fishing. Some of the local men (9) _____ (*fish*) out on the ice, and they (10) _____ (*look*) a bit strangely at this young Inuit woman with her traditional equipment. Anyway, I (11) _____ (*start*) catching fish, and pretty soon people (12) _____ (*notice*) that I (13) _____ (*catch*) more than the men with their high-tech equipment! People (14) _____ (*applaud*) every time I caught a fish and soon everyone (15) _____ (*laugh*) and congratulating me!

Finish Akna's blog entry with the right form of the verbs.

This (1) **happened** soon after Jordan and I (2) **moved** here. That day, it (3) **was snowing** and the wind (4) **was blowing** really hard. I (5) **had been** in Montreal for two months, and I (6) **missed** my family really badly. The St. Lawrence River (7) **had frozen** over a month before, and I (8) **decided** to go ice fishing. Some of the local men (9) **were fishing** out on the ice, and they (10) **looked** a bit strangely at this young Inuit woman with her traditional equipment. Anyway, I (11) **started** catching fish, and pretty soon people (12) **noticed** that I (13) **had caught** more than the men with their high-tech equipment! People (14) **applauded** every time I caught a fish and soon everyone (15) **was laughing** and congratulating me!

Work in small groups. Think of a time when you felt out of place or that you didn't fit in. Describe what happened. Did you all have similar experiences?

“We fell in love and eventually we got married and moved to Montreal. I did try to fit in, but I really suffered from culture shock and felt out of place.”

Listen to the conversations. Pay attention to which words are stressed.



Practice these short exchanges with a partner. Stress the italicized words.

A: Do you think it's important for friends to share the same values and goals in life?

B: No, but I ***do*** think it's important to share the same sense of humour.

A: You went to Somalia last year, didn't you?

B: No. I ***did*** go to Africa, but I didn't go to Somalia.

**Work in pairs. Read the conversation. Which two words should be stressed?
Underline them.**

A: I don't have a big social group, but I do have a few close friends.

B: Did you meet your friends at school?

A: No. I did make some friends there, but we've lost touch now.

Practice the conversation with your partner.

A: I don't have a big social group, but I do have a few close friends.

B: Did you meet your friends at school?

A: No. I did make some friends there, but we've lost touch now.

Read the magazine excerpt. Which person remembers a family member's annoying habit? What was it?

Kieran:

My dad always used to throw a cricket ball for me so I could practise my batting. He would never say he was too tired, even after working all day. He was sensitive and really understood how I felt. I try to remember that now when my little boy wants me to play with him!

Louise:

My little sister was always sneaking into my room and trying on my clothes. I used to get annoyed with her because she would my nice clothes all over the floor! Now we're the same size, and we're always borrowing each other's clothes!

The main rule:
We use “used to”
once, at the beginning,
and then “would” after
that.

Complete the family stories with one of the structures used to talk about habits. There may be more than one correct answer.

My brother is six years younger than me, and when he was young, he (1) _____ (*ask*) me to read him stories. He (2) _____ always _____ (*make*) me read the same story about four times, and he (3) _____ never _____ (*get*) bored! He (4) _____ (*carry*) his favourite book around with him.

When I was little, my dad worked a lot, so he couldn't spend much time with me. Every Sunday morning, however, we (4) _____ (*drive*) to the park and practice baseball. He (5) _____ (*spend*) hours throwing me balls and giving me advice. After that, we (6) _____ usually _____ (*go*) out for ice cream!

Complete the family stories with one of the structures used to talk about habits. There may be more than one correct answer.

My brother is six years younger than me, and when he was young, he (1) **used to ask** me to read him stories. He (2) **would always make** me read the same story about four times, and he (3) **would never get** bored! He (4) **would carry** his favourite book around with him everywhere he went.

When I was little, my dad worked a lot, so he couldn't spend much time with me. Every Sunday morning, however, we (4) **used to drive** to the park and practice baseball. He (5) **would spend** hours throwing me balls and giving me advice. After that, we (6) **would usually go** out for ice cream!

Writing with used to and would

Think about a fond memory that you have. Write a short paragraph (3-4 sentences) describing your memory.

Work in groups. Think of a past habit of yours, or of someone in your family, and tell your group about it. Ask each other questions about the effects of these habits, Afterwards, report back to the class on what you discussed.